ANKLE MOBILITY PROTOCOL

The daily 5-minute routine that fixes the squat hip shift

Left 6.3 cm | Right ~7-8 cm | Target: 9-10 both | Re-measure every 2 weeks

1 KNEE-TO-WALL PULSES

3 sets x 10-15 slow (LEFT x3, RIGHT x1-2)

Lunge stance, big toe ~10 cm from the wall. Drive the knee straight over the 2nd toe toward the wall - heel GLUED to the floor. The furthest reach = your score. This is the main drill.

2 SOLEUS STRETCH

3 x 30-45 s per side (LEFT holds longer)

Lunge stance, back knee BENT, back heel pressed down, lean into the wall until you feel the deep lower calf near the Achilles. Breathe, sink deeper every 10 s.

3 TIBIALIS RAISES

15-20 slow reps

Stand tall, heels planted. Lift the toes as high as possible, lower slow. Builds the shin muscle that controls the knee-over-toe motion you need for squat depth.

4 DEEP GOBLET HOLD

30-60 s

Light dumbbell/kettlebell at the chest. Drop to full squat depth, elbows press the knees out, heels down, chest tall. Doubles as your squat warm-up groove.

5 BANDED ANKLE DISTRACTION (skip if no band)

2-3 x 10-15 per side

Loop a resistance band around the lower shin, anchor it behind you. Drive the knee over the toes against the band's pull. The single best dorsiflexion builder there is.

THE RULES

- Start every unilateral set with the LEFT leg; the right side never does more reps
- Small plate (~5 lb) under the LEFT heel during squats until mobility catches up
- Film your squat from behind + side once a week; watch the hips stay between
- Any NEW pain in the squat (hip, knee, low back) -> campus health, stop the drill